

Quick notes

Agent Ecosystem Working Group 1:

Enterprise Agent Architecture - MACH Alliance

Sep 8, 2026

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Planning for the Amsterdam lab included infrastructure allocation, prototype status updates, and finalizing the event presentation strategy.

Agent Build Lab Event Logistics

- The agent build lab is scheduled for the 29th, from 12:30 to 4:00.
- The event will include a 30-minute intro session, prioritizing operational setup over extensive education to ensure hands-on time.
- Agreed to print simplified 'paint by numbers' documentation for participants to reference during the lab.
- A Vercel account with \$500 in LLM credits is provisioned for participant use during the event.

Documentation and Archetype Refinement

- Patrick recommended restructuring documentation to prioritize clear 'What, Why, and When' definitions for each archetype.
- Planned to present a single 1-slide summary of archetypes during the intro, rather than a slide per archetype.

- Tim and Patrick identified a potential opportunity to merge Archetype 1 and 2 to create a more robust implementation.

Concept: Software Factories

- Identified the 'Factory' model as a potential post-event focus, shifting from individual agents to standardized, pipeline-based engineering departments.
- Everett demonstrated a closed-loop 'backlog.md' workflow where agents interact with a CLI to triage and execute bug fixes.
- George emphasized that effective factory models require defined doctrines and conventions to maintain code quality.

Next steps

- ☐ [Daniele Stroppa] Provision AWS Accounts: Provision AWS accounts with access to Bedrock for participants to test models without using personal credits.
- ☐ [George Fitzgibbons] Add Vercel Users: Add event participants to the Vercel account to provide access to infrastructure and credits.
- ☐ [George Fitzgibbons, Daniele Stroppa] Coordinate Usage: Coordinate on infrastructure patterns for LLM gateway and Bedrock usage prior to the event.
- ☐ [George Fitzgibbons] Write Documentation: Write up documentation content for the agent build lab archetypes.
- ☐ [Rebecca Lyus] Handle Printing: Organize printing of the agent lab documentation for use during the in-person event.
- ☐ [Tim Benniks, Patrick Bosek] Coordinate Archetypes: Connect offline to discuss the development of archetypes 1 and 2.
- ☐ [Tim Benniks] Submit PR: Submit the pull request for the archetype implementations.
- ☐ [Rebecca Lyus] Post Meetup Poll: Post a poll in the Slack channel to determine availability for an in-person meetup.
- ☐ [Tim Benniks] Check seasonal availability: Verify if requested local food items are in season during the Mac X conference.
- ☐ [Tim Benniks] Compile dining recommendations: Create a list of recommended local dishes and food spots for the group members.

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Full notes

Sep 8, 2026

Agent Ecosystem Working Group 1: Enterprise Agent Architecture - MACH Alliance

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Meeting records [📄 Transcript](#)

Summary

Planning for the Amsterdam lab included infrastructure allocation, prototype status updates, and finalizing the event presentation strategy.

Lab Logistics and Infrastructure

The Amsterdam lab is scheduled for the 29th. Infrastructure resources including Amazon Web Services and Vercel credits were allocated to support participants.

Strategy and Prototype Development

The team decided the event will feature a 30-minute presentation followed by hands-on lab time. Updates were provided regarding the status of the 5 baseline archetypes.

Factory Concept and Context

Discussions covered the factory model where agents manage automated workflows. Organizational restructuring provided context on how artificial intelligence can support team performance during transitions.

Decisions

Aligned

- **Presentation format shifted to operational focus** The Agent Build Lab in-person presentation structure is changed to prioritize operational clarity regarding archetypes over conceptual theory, utilizing a simplified single-slide taxonomy.
- **Slack poll for attendee tracking** The group will utilize a Slack hand-raise poll to finalize the list of in-person attendees and identify those available to assist with event facilitation.
- **Archetype 1 merged into Archetype 2** Archetype 1 is retired and its concepts will be incorporated into the scope of Archetype 2 rather than maintained as a distinct archetype.

Next steps

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Details

- **Amsterdam Agent Build Lab Scheduling:** Rebecca Lyus confirmed the Agent Build Lab is scheduled for the 29th, from 12:30 to 4:00 PM. The team discussed the desire to meet as a group either before or during the event, and Rebecca Lyus offered to facilitate that coordination ([00:02:07](#)).
- **Infrastructure and Resource Management:** The group discussed available infrastructure for the lab, including Vercel and AWS ([00:03:11](#)). George

Fitzgibbons noted they have a Vercel account with unlimited seats and \$500 in LLM credits for the event, which they will provide to participants ([00:06:16](#)). Daniele Stroppa offered to provision AWS accounts with Bedrock access to ensure participants can test models without using their personal credits ([00:04:11](#)). Tim Benniks suggested incorporating AI Gateway for additional inference credits, and the team plans to discuss this offline to finalize the setup ([00:05:26](#)).

- **Agent Archetypes and Prototype Status:** George Fitzgibbons explained there are five baseline buckets, or archetypes, to serve as starting points for participants ([00:03:11](#)) ([00:07:10](#)). Archetypes four and five are provisioned, and archetype three has been submitted ([00:04:11](#)) ([00:29:59](#)). The status of archetypes one and two remains under discussion; Tim Benniks and Patrick Bosek plan to connect offline to determine if they should be simplified or merged, with Patrick Bosek suggesting the use of GitHub Actions for archetype one ([00:08:18](#)) ([00:31:15](#)).
- **Lab Presentation Strategy:** The team agreed the Agent Build Lab will consist of a 30-minute overview followed by hands-on time ([00:09:58](#)). To maximize efficiency, they plan to limit the presentation to approximately six slides, focusing on operations, a clear taxonomy of the documentation, and how to participate, rather than extensive conceptual lectures ([00:12:51](#)). Patrick Bosek offered to provide cliff notes on the existing documentation to help refine this content ([00:10:54](#)).
- **In-Person Attendance and Logistics:** The group intends to use a Slack poll to confirm who will be in person, allowing for better allocation of support at the event. Confirmed attendees include Tim Benniks, Daniele Stroppa, George Fitzgibbons, Everett Zufelt, and Patrick Bosek, while Morten Næss noted they would be unable to participate in the lab due to other priorities ([00:15:27](#)) ([00:18:20](#)). The group plans to coordinate their arrivals on Sunday and Monday to prepare for the session ([00:17:22](#)).
- **Software Factory Concept:** George Fitzgibbons and Everett Zufelt led a discussion on the "factory" concept in software development, where agents manage workflows including ticket triage, code commits, and pull requests ([00:19:30](#)). Everett Zufelt shared their experience building a "product owner" agent that triages bugs from a backlog, and the group discussed the

importance of establishing shared doctrines and conventions within a factory setting to ensure quality and safety ([00:21:36](#)) ([00:27:42](#)).

- **Workplace Reorganization Update:** Tim Benniks shared that they have been managing a significant organizational restructuring at their workplace, which has impacted their capacity but has also highlighted the potential for AI to support team performance during such transitions ([00:32:50](#)).
- **Meeting Closing:** The participants concluded the meeting with brief discussions regarding local food recommendations in Amsterdam, such as stroopwafels and traditional fries ([00:34:49](#)).

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Transcript

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00:00:38

Daniele Stroppa: Hey,

Rebecca Lyus: Hello. How are you doing?

Daniele Stroppa: I'm very good, thanks. How are things?

Rebecca Lyus: Not too bad. Can't believe we're now 3 weeks out.

Daniele Stroppa: Yeah. Yeah. Almost there.

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah, it's gone by so quickly this summer.

Daniele Stroppa: Yeah. I don't know. I feel like the the last few years have have just flown by.

Rebecca Lyus: Mhm. They really have.

Daniele Stroppa: Hey

George Fitzgibbons: Hey, how are you?

Rebecca Lyus: I know.

George Fitzgibbons: Hey, Rebecca.

Patrick Bosek: Good morning or afternoon.

Rebecca Lyus: Good morning.

George Fitzgibbons: Come relax.

Rebecca Lyus: Just going to give it a few more minutes and then we can get stuck in

Daniele Stroppa: Good to see you, Morten.

Morten Næss: It's been a while.

Daniele Stroppa: I know I am.

Morten Næss: I saw you're you're coming to Amsterdam.

Daniele Stroppa: Yes. Uh, did I see you there?

Morten Næss: Yeah, of course.

Daniele Stroppa: Yeah,

Morten Næss: Um,

Daniele Stroppa: of course.

Morten Næss: inventory

Patrick Bosek: question about Amsterdam. When is there a meetup for this group in Amsterdam?

00:02:07

Rebecca Lyus: Well, uh we are doing the agent build lab which is going to be on the

Patrick Bosek: Yeah.

Rebecca Lyus: 29th uh from 12:30 until I believe 4 if memory serves. Um but I would absolutely love for us to be able to get together either beforehand or during the event. Let me know and I can facilitate.

Patrick Bosek: That sounds great. So for the agent build lab, um I've never been to a MACH before, so if these are like extremely rudimentary questions, like you know, maybe we could take them offline.

Tim Benniks: I think none of us know. Patrick,

Patrick Bosek: Um okay,

Tim Benniks: we're good.

Patrick Bosek: great. Um what are we expected to contribute to the agent build lab? Like how can we help?

Rebecca Lyus: So that's something I wanted to go over today.

Patrick Bosek: Okay, cool.

Rebecca Lyus: Uh just because we are now in crunch time and uh I just wanted to go over it, go over logistics, uh what we still need to do, just make sure everyone's happy.

Patrick Bosek: Sounds good.

00:03:11

Rebecca Lyus: Um but yeah,

Tim Benniks: So Rebecca actually um I had a look at all these different software things we could use um for this labs and it's actually quite wide ranging

Rebecca Lyus: yes.

Tim Benniks: and I might want to just paste those here in like our Slack channel so you guys can have a look because I know George you've been doing a lot with Eve. Maybe if you guys can sponsor that is just the easiest way because most of them are behind like small pay walls and stuff.

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah.

Tim Benniks: So I'm not sure we want to do that with Mac Alliance.

George Fitzgibbons: Thanks.

Tim Benniks: I don't know how that would work.

George Fitzgibbons: Yeah. And maybe hop right into it. And I think in past conversations last week, the week or whenever we did this, um I think the general outcome and to maybe answer your question too, Patrick, is I think we're going to have the four base or five baseline buckets as starters. And to the point of um I did bucket three. Bucket three is built with Eve.

00:04:11

George Fitzgibbons: Anybody can take it. You can hit deploy. uh there's a free Verscell account so it's easy to deploy but to the point Danielle uh did it with another open-source framework and correct me if I'm wrong Danielle but yours is five and you did it with um I can't remember but there'll be four

Daniele Stroppa: for you.

George Fitzgibbons: there'll be different patterns so there will be some optionality of hey you can choose this infrastructure pattern and do it uh that being said like if you coales on like two or three uh that definitely helps but uh Versel will and Eve will certainly be an option and that is something that's fully provisioned and uh ready to go and so to

Daniele Stroppa: And I was just going to add if we need um like accounts or if we need a way for people to test it out without using their credits in terms of um LLMs, in terms of using um models, without using their APIs, their credits. Um, I can provision a set of AWS accounts with access to to Bedrock. So, they can just point to to those models.

00:05:26

Daniele Stroppa: So, we have that option

Tim Benniks: That would be nice.

Everett Zufelt: I'm gonna jump in and suggest Rebecca,

Tim Benniks: That would be very nice.

Rebecca Lyus: Mhm.

Everett Zufelt: is this something you can deal with offline between It sounds like Danielle and George would be

Rebecca Lyus: Yep.

Everett Zufelt: the right two people. Is it like I The whole group here can't answer the question, but I think the three of you are the right three people to answer the question.

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah.

George Fitzgibbons: Let's Yeah,

Tim Benniks: So, I did do some research.

George Fitzgibbons: we have a quick chat.

Tim Benniks: I put it in the channel. But if you guys actually have access to give people some sort of thing, it's easier if you guys take care of it because Daniele just spin up some stuff with bad rocket and be happy, right? Um George,

George Fitzgibbons: Yeah.

Daniele Stroppa: Yep.

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah.

Tim Benniks: maybe AI gateway is also one because it gives \$5 for free so people can have some

George Fitzgibbons: Well,

Tim Benniks: inference.

George Fitzgibbons: so just quickly on that point, uh, so we have an account with unlimited seats and \$500 in credit for the event.

00:06:16

George Fitzgibbons: So anybody who wants to participate in the event, the So you got the Verscell account.

Rebecca Lyus: Okay.

George Fitzgibbons: I added you to uh like I foresee anybody who wants to use

Tim Benniks: Yep.

George Fitzgibbons: resell or participate I will just add to that account that uncount is uncapped mi or like unit so you can use whatever infra you want and there'll be \$500 LOM credit in there so if you burn if we burn through that in the two hours all good um but if we can have some combination of bedrock and um LLM gateway credits I think That'll be plenty. So, maybe closer to the event. And again, not to Derell, uh, Rebecca, maybe we can even have like a prompt sign up flow of, hey, join this team if you're going to be at the agent lab. Um,

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah, I feel

Tim Benniks: Yeah.

George Fitzgibbons: so we a week ahead of time.

Tim Benniks: So we know Yeah.

George Fitzgibbons: So, but let's catch up Daniele and we can kind of continue and we can come up with that pattern.

00:07:10

Daniele Stroppa: Mhm.

George Fitzgibbons: But I think to the point to the point uh too with Patrick,

Rebecca Lyus: Perfect.

George Fitzgibbons: you know, the general plan is it's a we have these buckets, these agents, and those are going to be starting points, but people can build whatever they want.

Rebecca Lyus: Yes. Um, okay. So, we've got the systems kind of underway. People are getting underway with all the prototypes that's going into GitHub. Is anyone concerned about the prototype they're working on?

George Fitzgibbons: I made it.

Tim Benniks: Maybe mine because it's one it's so simple.

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah.

Tim Benniks: If I start using code to do that one, maybe it's too much already. I don't even know kind of do I use maybe an N8 flow or something cuz one is really like people are doing stuff and then asking an agent to maybe translate something and then it comes back and so it's really not very deep. But if that is done through code, maybe that's already too deep. So that was my one question. So I decided not to start.

00:08:18

Rebecca Lyus: That's fair.

Tim Benniks: It's easy though.

Rebecca Lyus: um once we know it it is just

Tim Benniks: So once I once we know we build it. Yeah.

Rebecca Lyus: I'm not too worried about how deep something goes just on the basis that people who can go have a look if they want to do it can pick and choose. So if they look at it go,

Tim Benniks: Sure.

Rebecca Lyus: that's a bit much for me. That's okay cuz they have other options.

Tim Benniks: Okay. I'll I'll I'll have a like if somebody has an opinion, feel free to share. Otherwise, just have a look and see.

Rebecca Lyus: Okay. Um, so that's the Okay.

Patrick Bosek: One of Oh, sorry, Tim. One of the things, maybe we should talk about this offline. Um, one of the things that might be an interesting pattern for um an archetype one agent would be you doing something around like GitHub actions. Um,

Rebecca Lyus: Mhm.

Patrick Bosek: so those are like really super available to everybody.

Tim Benniks: Interesting.

00:09:17

Tim Benniks: Yep.

Patrick Bosek: They're fairly capable. Um, easy to deploy. So, I don't know. Do you want to connect offline? We could I could show you some of the stuff I built with that.

Tim Benniks: Oh, that's nice. I was thinking something way less techy, but actually GitHub action just runs.

Patrick Bosek: Yeah,

Tim Benniks: You get inference for free from GitHub and or it runs at least for free.

Patrick Bosek: I I'm actually still using my my claw uh I'm I've only done it with with cloud enterprise API. Um but I you're right. I think there is a way to do it with free inference.

Tim Benniks: Maybe get Oh,

Patrick Bosek: I'm just I haven't done that.

Tim Benniks: interesting.

Patrick Bosek: Yeah.

Tim Benniks: Let's connect offline because we can maybe make like the simplest thing that as an agent figures out if there's a bug in a translation or whatever, something like that. Okay, cool.

Patrick Bosek: Yeah,

Tim Benniks: Appreciate it.

Patrick Bosek: it's super easy to deploy,

Rebecca Lyus: Right.

Tim Benniks: Thanks.

00:09:58

Patrick Bosek: too. So,

Tim Benniks: Yeah,

Patrick Bosek: let's talk about that.

Rebecca Lyus: Uh teamwork makes the room work. We love that.

Tim Benniks: there you go.

Rebecca Lyus: Then so that's the second half of the agent build lab. The first half is going to be a 30inut overview. Uh I don't know if anyone's seen Holly's post. Uh but Cisco and Agenty have offered up some support. I don't know how you guys want to present. So this is very much free form. Are you going to be doing a presentation? Are you going to be talking to people? Cuz George, I know you mentioned uh showing some stuff on a screen. So, we're sorting out screen.

Everett Zufelt: Do we have Patrick on?

Rebecca Lyus: Um,

Everett Zufelt: Do we have Patrick on the call?

Rebecca Lyus: we do.

Everett Zufelt: Patrick,

Patrick Bosek: Sure.

Everett Zufelt: I think you you were going to maybe try to help facilitate a little bit of the conversation around the content. Did you want to jump in?

00:10:54

Patrick Bosek: Um, so I was I think we had talked about the content in the GitHub, which I actually have a bunch of notes that I was going to share with today. Um,

Rebecca Lyus: Mhm.

Patrick Bosek: did you want my perspective on the content around the agent build lab in person because that I hadn't really spent much time thinking about.

Everett Zufelt: I think I think maybe just help I I think the two things are not the same but they're related in such a way that probably even if you just help facilitate the discussion around

Patrick Bosek: Okay.

Everett Zufelt: it like I think at the end of the day developers want to get their hands dirty and and

Patrick Bosek: Sure. Right.

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah.

Everett Zufelt: so we don't want to talk their ears off but probably there's an amount of talking that helps Set everything up for success.

Patrick Bosek: Yeah.

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah.

Patrick Bosek: Okay. I think that's fair. Um I actually Okay, maybe I can just do like the cliffnotes version of the review I had done of the documentation because I I think you're right.

00:11:45

Patrick Bosek: I think some of it does transfer. Is this a good moment to do that,

Rebecca Lyus: Mhm.

Patrick Bosek: Rebecca?

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah.

Patrick Bosek: Okay. Um, so I went through and I read all the docs in the in the GitHub um for all the different archetypes. Uh, and I have some just general suggestions that I think would elevate them a bit or or help people understand them. Um, as it relates to what we'd be doing in person in Amsterdam, I think the probably the highest impact thing would be to save a lot of the conceptual conversation um, and make that more reference and then bring a lot more of the like very clear what and then like the why, how, and when conversation ahead. So if you go and you look at the way that the docs are structured, um actually we'll open them up. Um so they all start with what changes here, uh which for someone coming in cold is it's like a very odd pattern as an initial heading. And I kind of get why we went that direction now that I've read all of them.

00:12:51

Patrick Bosek: But I think if we started with like very clear definitions, I know this would be a little repetitive from the intro, which I think the intro is actually that's another comment. they from orchestration to automation. I think that would be something we present more in person like we would do that like what these things are. Um but I do think people diving in having very clear what's and then like why and when's would make it a little bit um yeah that's that's that's where I'm going with this is like we're very clear about what the archetypes Yeah.

Tim Benniks: So it could just be five slides explaining the archetypes and when they actually hit and when you have to

Patrick Bosek: Yeah.

Tim Benniks: switch maybe and I we have to figure out a way when we start working with people how we can add the depth at that moment like do we give

Patrick Bosek: Mhm.

Tim Benniks: examples and then dive in or because we will have different opinions. They all matter, but maybe not on the main stage.

Patrick Bosek: I think

00:13:45

George Fitzgibbons: I think to that point I think there it's only a half hour and so to your point Tim I think a lot of yeah the f like the overview I feel like

Tim Benniks: That first pitch. Oh, this is six slides and go.

George Fitzgibbons: is so six slides in operational this is what we're going

Tim Benniks: be fine.

Patrick Bosek: Yeah.

George Fitzgibbons: to do how you can sign up how you can like the operational aspect I think needs to take precedent o over like education and that it's got to tee everything up because the lab is going to be where people dive in get hands-on so it is maybe to Patrick's point like a clear taxonomy of the documentation this is what it is i.e those five slides and then this is how you participate.

Patrick Bosek: Yeah,

Tim Benniks: Maybe that's enough,

Patrick Bosek: I think that makes sense.

Tim Benniks: right, Patrick?

Patrick Bosek: I I don't I don't even think we need a slide for each archetype.

Tim Benniks: But and then Yeah.

Patrick Bosek: I think we could do it all in one slide.

00:14:37

Patrick Bosek: Um Yeah.

Tim Benniks: And then print it and give it to people so they can look back. Maybe that simple. We go old school.

Patrick Bosek: Right. Yeah. I I think I think the simpler you are with this the the better. I do think having so personally I think that archetypes like probably one through three are the most reasonable to go over or to like to try to execute on inside of the um the lab.

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah.

Patrick Bosek: But I mean like that's just my personal opinion. Um it might be useful to have examples of like where those are effective. Um so like if you're trying to solve this kind of problem like this archetype tends to be a good solution for it or like you should try this. Um I don't think it needs to be perfect,

Rebecca Lyus: Heat.

Patrick Bosek: but I think if people are given like a little bit of a paint by numbers, you know, if you're thinking about this, try this. Um that's going to just get them moving a lot faster.

00:15:27

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah,

George Fitzgibbons: Cool.

Rebecca Lyus: I can get the stuff sorted for the printing. We just need it written up.

George Fitzgibbons: Yeah, I can run. I'll write something up.

Tim Benniks: So,

Rebecca Lyus: Okay.

Tim Benniks: Rebecca, do we know who's going to be in person already. I know you sent some emails, but

Rebecca Lyus: I I did I I sent some emails. Uh I haven't got people spec um

Tim Benniks: because based on that knowledge, we know who's in the room and can help out and stuff.

George Fitzgibbons: Yeah,

Tim Benniks: like I one thing get I'll I'll have

George Fitzgibbons: I think we took raised hands last time. You're going to be there, right, Tim?

Tim Benniks: to be there because the next day I have to do uh certifications dev lab for content con same thing essentially a little bit little bit deeper so I'll be

George Fitzgibbons: Danielle, you're gonna be there.

Daniele Stroppa: I'll be there as well.

George Fitzgibbons: You're gonna be I'm gonna be there.

Daniele Stroppa: Yeah.

Tim Benniks: there Morten I'm sure

George Fitzgibbons: Any ever anybody else here?

00:16:31

George Fitzgibbons: More sweet.

Tim Benniks: you're There.

Morten Næss: Yeah, I'll be there.

George Fitzgibbons: Do you want to participate in the agent lab or you got other more important

Morten Næss: Uh, well, the thing is,

George Fitzgibbons: business?

Morten Næss: well, I I'm I'm in in the middle of a DD, so I'm sitting this one out. It's uh brutal.

George Fitzgibbons: Okay.

Morten Næss: So, but uh I I'll be back, but I I'll be I'll help in any way I can,

Tim Benniks: Oh boy.

George Fitzgibbons: Let's Yeah,

Morten Næss: but you know how it is. Uh priorities

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah,

George Fitzgibbons: let's just let's just do like a Slack hand raise about twofold.

Rebecca Lyus: I

Tim Benniks: Yeah, sure.

George Fitzgibbons: Who's going to be there and who can help out?

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah, that would be fantastic cuz then we can basically allocate people to whatever table they want to go to. Um, I say allocate loosely.

Tim Benniks: Yeah, we'll be flying around tables,

Rebecca Lyus: Um yeah,

Tim Benniks: I'm sure.

Rebecca Lyus: this is it.

George Fitzgibbons: Um,

Rebecca Lyus: Um

00:17:22

George Fitzgibbons: cool. We can

Rebecca Lyus: so from there, what day are people arriving? Cuz if you all wanted to meet up.

Tim Benniks: We need some prep as well, right?

Everett Zufelt: Yeah,

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah.

Everett Zufelt: I'm arriving on

Tim Benniks: Or we just walk into a finished room, Rebecca. That's what we expect.

Rebecca Lyus: Would you like to walk into a finished room?

Tim Benniks: Yes, of course.

Rebecca Lyus: Because I feel like that will

Everett Zufelt: there.

Tim Benniks: I'm just kidding.

Everett Zufelt: There's what you'd like to do. And what's I I will show up on Sunday.

Tim Benniks: Oh, I know. That's of course

Everett Zufelt: I I'm arriving on Sunday noonish. So,

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah.

Everett Zufelt: I will be quite jet-lagged when I arrive.

Daniele Stroppa: Sorry.

Everett Zufelt: So Monday's better. Sunday's good for drinking beer.

Tim Benniks: in Amsterdam. Yes, Everett.

Patrick Bosek: Yeah.

Tim Benniks: Like I arrive Monday afternoon because I'm driving this time.

Rebecca Lyus: Okay.

Tim Benniks: Um yeah, I'm I'm assuming Monday morning you already needed to be there for for some people at least, right?

00:18:20

Daniele Stroppa: I'll arrive Monday morning,

Rebecca Lyus: So I'm going to from Sunday

Daniele Stroppa: too.

Rebecca Lyus: midday

Tim Benniks: Okay, I'll try to change a bit of my schedule so that I'll be there at midday as well. So then we can, you know, help facilitate and set up and because I'm sure when we walk into the room, people will have some questions and then if we know what's going to happen for later, it's better than it's a surprise.

Rebecca Lyus: 100%. Um, I will try and get off the area that I'm managing as early as possible so I can come and help set up as well.

Patrick Bosek: Um, I arrived very early on Sunday, so I second Everett when saying that uh happy to drink on Sunday.

Tim Benniks: I'll try to come earlier.

Morten Næss: I'll I'll join you guys.

Tim Benniks: So, I'm also happy to drink on Sunday.

Morten Næss: I'm coming in Sunday nightish.

Tim Benniks: Oh, nice.

Rebecca Lyus: Okay.

George Fitzgibbons: Can I ask a general question? Uh,

Rebecca Lyus: Yep.

George Fitzgibbons: are we good on Mac X kind of operationally right now?

00:19:30

George Fitzgibbons: I gotta leave at 11:32.

Rebecca Lyus: Um, yeah,

George Fitzgibbons: Okay.

Rebecca Lyus: I feel like we're we're quite underway for MacX now.

George Fitzgibbons: Is anybody building uh agent factories or software factories?

Tim Benniks: depends what that means. Can mean anything

Everett Zufelt: Yeah, I can say yes given I I'd like Kevin's answer. Sure, I am.

Tim Benniks: probably. Yes,

George Fitzgibbons: Uh so I'll describe the workflow.

Tim Benniks: probably.

George Fitzgibbons: Um,

Everett Zufelt: Sure.

George Fitzgibbons: I use linear, I use Jira, I a ticket comes in, I tag whatever I call my factory. I say factory fix this. Then it goes through a series of agents to make a PR, approve it, and automerge it. There's a very, have you heard of factory AI?

Everett Zufelt: Yeah,

George Fitzgibbons: It's they call

Everett Zufelt: that's I I they've got a I think they're pointed in roughly the right direction. I think there's parts of their platform that are not quite there yet, but I think they're their vision and their direction feels right to me.

George Fitzgibbons: Okay.

00:20:38

George Fitzgibbons: So, I've started to roll my own and seen people rolling their own and the I love the term factory.

Tim Benniks: I think it's pretty cool.

George Fitzgibbons: Uh but

Tim Benniks: Most people will be rolling their own I'm sure. George, I am for sure based on what you just said.

George Fitzgibbons: uh is anybody so have you made an end to end factory with

Tim Benniks: Yes.

George Fitzgibbons: agents

Tim Benniks: Only I've I've done it slightly differently where I just build a little CLI where I select what happens and then the agents just take it away. So it's not it's not like it's looking at well I have tickets but I say work on this ticket now but I can also have it work on six tickets and then but it's it's a little bit more manual in the beginning at

Everett Zufelt: Yeah,

Tim Benniks: least of course.

George Fitzgibbons: Do you tag it in the ticketing system or do you

Everett Zufelt: I'm I'm Oh,

Tim Benniks: Yeah it's all connected. Yes it makes branches all the things

George Fitzgibbons: Okay.

Everett Zufelt: I I'm I'm I'm doing a So, I'm doing So, I've decided to use something called backlog.md, which is basically like imagine a very rudimentary Jira or linear, but it's all saved.

00:21:36

Everett Zufelt: on on disk as markdown files, but there's a CLI that lets you like interact with that directory of files.

Tim Benniks: Oh,

Everett Zufelt: So,

Tim Benniks: nice.

Everett Zufelt: and the the nice part about that is you can version control the backlog with the code. Um, and it because it's personal, not business that I'm playing around with it. It's just one less thing to sign up for. Um, but then I'm I'm building a multi-user uh game. And so I actually have a fleet of agent players who play the game. But one of the instructions they have is if you run into anything in the game that's confusing, too hard, complicated, not explained well enough, etc., etc., go file a backlog ticket. And then I've got another agent that monitors the backlog and triages and decides which of them to actually execute against. So like it's closed loop. There's agent essentially players users testers filing tickets and then another agent who can pick up those tickets from the backlog and decide whether or not to implement the change.

00:22:46

Tim Benniks: Yeah. So basically like everybody has a second brain,

Everett Zufelt: And 15-year-old Mi's head Yeah.

Tim Benniks: you know.

Everett Zufelt: And 15-year-old Mi's head explodes with how awesome the world became.

Tim Benniks: Exactly. And so George, everybody Yes. Are you planning to make this um an archetype kind of thing?

George Fitzgibbons: I'm not playing anything. Maybe it is, maybe it's not. Uh

Tim Benniks: Because this is one of those things that is very interesting where we now see that individualistically people are incredible with AI. The moment it has to come together in teams, it's harder and this helps that sometimes. But this is also why everybody makes their own second brain and their own factory and it kind of works for them and it's really hard to standardize that because these developers need their freedom to do their own thing kind of. You know what I mean?

George Fitzgibbons: Well,

Daniele Stroppa: What?

George Fitzgibbons: I think the standardization comes from the idea of a factory. Uh like you have a thousand person engineering team.

00:23:45

George Fitzgibbons: You are not standalone engineers now. You work in a factory. Like look at how a car is made now.

Tim Benniks: Yeah,

George Fitzgibbons: comes in.

Tim Benniks: sure.

George Fitzgibbons: The agents are the things that come down and put the tires on. the humans just stand there and check some boxes now and then. Like I feel like the idea of a factory is everybody all engineers are in there working but it is all one pipeline and so sorry

Tim Benniks: It's really interesting.

Daniele Stroppa: I think this to me this sounds like a good next. what's next or next step, right?

Tim Benniks: Yeah,

Daniele Stroppa: Now that we have defined like the the different types of agents,

Tim Benniks: you're right.

Daniele Stroppa: how do they work together? Right? And and to me that that is that would be a good way of explaining, right? Like different types of agent, different work. You pick whichever archetype fits better for that particular task and then they work together in that factory style.

Tim Benniks: Actually, this is great.

00:24:42

Tim Benniks: You might have defined postmach x for us now.

George Fitzgibbons: a little stuck. Keep thinking on it. But yeah, to the idea,

Tim Benniks: It's really interesting.

George Fitzgibbons: it's more it's a department. It is an engineering department. They go in and they check in at the factory. The agents are just tools that they can solve anything. Somebody has a broken link on the website. One agent may be good at front ends. Another agent may be good at backends, but it can kind of determine which tool to use on which job. And sometimes a human has to say, "Use this tool, use that tool." But the agent should be able to figure out which tool to use. And the human should look at the output of, "Oh, cool. You fixed it. It's good." the car works. Move on. And it's I don't know. I think the term factory makes a ton of sense when it comes to it's not just agents talking together. It's tools solving whatever jobs that come in and the entire

00:25:39

Tim Benniks: Yeah, I think if we solve it for non-technical people as well,

George Fitzgibbons: engineering team can do it.

Tim Benniks: then this becomes a real thing like Grockbot is trying to do, right? It has multiple agents that can do things on their own computer. People don't really have to understand how it works. If it becomes more seamless like that, but developers can still go ham on it, that's when it becomes successful. Not sure how that would work yet, but it's interesting nonetheless.

George Fitzgibbons: Yeah.

Tim Benniks: It's less easy, but if you don't get buy in from a marketer, developer can scream whatever they want, you know, for real success.

George Fitzgibbons: Yeah. But and ever say it again. Uh we'll say it slower. You go to somebody files a sport ticket in a an agent sees

Everett Zufelt: Oh. So, so this is like a game.

George Fitzgibbons: an issue.

Everett Zufelt: Yeah. So, it's a game I built, right? Like I'm building a game, you know, on a side of my desk for for fun.

00:26:43

Everett Zufelt: Um,

George Fitzgibbons: You define the game quick.

Everett Zufelt: and so I have uh

George Fitzgibbons: Is it a some sort of front end with some sort of back end?

Everett Zufelt: mult. Yes.

George Fitzgibbons: No, just from a technical perspective.

Everett Zufelt: Assume assume mud. Like think Mud but with a web but with a web front end instead of with

George Fitzgibbons: Oh,

Tim Benniks: Wow. Intense.

Everett Zufelt: a web front end instead of tet. So front end and back end,

George Fitzgibbons: okay.

Everett Zufelt: but then I built a fleet of agent players. So there's non-player characters in the game already, but I built a fleet of agent players who log in and they're LLM driven and they play the game. But one of the instructions that those agent players have in their system prompt is, hey, if you run across anything hard, confusing, broken, dumb, whatever, use this backlog.md service to file a bug. So like there are agents actively playing the game who when they run across things file

George Fitzgibbons: Yeah. Okay.

00:27:42

Everett Zufelt: bugs just like humans would. Um, and then but I wanted to find a bunch of the bugs before I ship it. And then there's another agent that looks at that backlog and decides whether or not to ask Claude to go fix the bug.

George Fitzgibbons: would you call that agent the foreman?

Everett Zufelt: Borman triage or something like product owner.

George Fitzgibbons: I I in I only in the I'm only in the context of building software

Everett Zufelt: I mean, I think I'd call it I would call it a

George Fitzgibbons: like not not testing. So everything out of the output of something is broken.

Everett Zufelt: I s I'd call it a product I'd

George Fitzgibbons: Can we start there?

Everett Zufelt: call it a product owner because it's effectively making a product decision,

George Fitzgibbons: Okay. Product owner.

Everett Zufelt: right? This bug that virtual Tim filed,

George Fitzgibbons: Yeah.

Everett Zufelt: are we going to fix it or not? Right? So, I'd call it a product owner.

George Fitzgibbons: Okay. So, the product owner says something needs to get fixed.

00:28:35

Everett Zufelt: Yep.

George Fitzgibbons: Where does that go? Does it go to some place that says, "Let's fix that." And where is that environment?

Everett Zufelt: Yeah. It gets tagged. It gets tagged in that backlog MD uh issue queue as like you know whatever the tag is that it sticks on it to say this is approved for work.

George Fitzgibbons: and then who works on it and then

Everett Zufelt: Claude would pick it up from the list.

George Fitzgibbons: Claude makes a PR are.

Everett Zufelt: probably just commits the code frankly because remember this is like side of my desk personal project but yes like I would think in a professional setting that's not the side of my desk yes it would be a pull request

George Fitzgibbons: Okay,

Everett Zufelt: yeah

George Fitzgibbons: that's what I'm thinking about is the second half of how stuff gets built. Now, with the context of that term factory,

Everett Zufelt: I like yeah I think that that feels like the right flow um to me I think the I think there's also I mean there's all there's like the whatever GitHub's thing spec kit or whatever there's another interesting one that I ran across recently called spec kitty I mean there's a bunch that all do the same thing but I think the other the other thing that you want in the factory are doctrines and conventions and rules right so we never use PNPM we always use npm or like

00:29:59

Everett Zufelt: we always use react, we don't use Vue, we always do this, we don't do so like I think the other thing a factory needs on on top of the workflow is the doctrines and conventions that all the factory workers have to follow so that they don't well you

know to overextend the analysis so that nobody gets hurt so that quality stays high and nobody gets hurt.

George Fitzgibbons: Okay, I'm going to leave at 11:30. Sorry to start that conversation, but there we go. That's why I'm interested.

Everett Zufelt: Cool.

Tim Benniks: Wow, we still have half an hour. And did we time box it too good today?

Rebecca Lyus: I mean,

Tim Benniks: It's almost impossible.

Everett Zufelt: Uh,

Rebecca Lyus: if we need to take the time back so we can do stuff, that is okay. Unless someone has something they want to show, demonstrate

Everett Zufelt: I just have a quick question which is uh I see George um did a poll request for archetype 3 and I took a look and I shared some feedback of him on that. Uh, and maybe Tim, you may have mentioned this already, you may not have, I don't know, but do are you nearing ready to submit a poll request for archetypes one and two?

00:31:15

Tim Benniks: Yeah. So, I had a look and there is something for two already, but I'm wondering maybe I should also take that. But I'll talk to Patrick to see because he had some opinions because I just asked that question where I wasn't fully sure what tech to use because it's so simple. But based on what Patrick was saying, maybe if we do a quick connect somewhere this week, I will have that ready very fast. That's not a problem. Like it's not the work that's hard.

Everett Zufelt: Okay.

Tim Benniks: It's just conceptually I kind of want to figure it out first because

Everett Zufelt: Yep. Where did you say that you saw two was already done?

Tim Benniks: it's I think my claw told me that. Let me check. And if claw was wrong, I'll do two as well.

Everett Zufelt: I don't I don't think there is. All All I know about is f four and five are published. Three has been submitted. I don't see anything around one and two, but one isn't I think we all decided one isn't really an agent.

00:32:08

Tim Benniks: No,

Everett Zufelt: So like I'd be completely fine if we just did two and skipped one.

Tim Benniks: exactly.

Everett Zufelt: There's a reason why we're,

Tim Benniks: That's a exactly I'll talk to Patrick if you send me a message.

Everett Zufelt: you know. Yeah.

Tim Benniks: Patrick, I'll figure out a calendar moment with you. You know what? We might skip one or we do it at the simplest thing where it's like an N8 run where it just finds a page, finds and then uses an AI to find like a typo or something and then it comes back and says, "Hey, there's a typo." And then a user can fix it,

Everett Zufelt: You could also you could also consider just rolling it in as a capability in

Tim Benniks: you know.

Everett Zufelt: archetype 2 and then you can talk about them both in the same well that's what I'm saying right and then and then

Tim Benniks: Well, it is. Yeah. Yeah,

Everett Zufelt: rather than having like a fifth thing it just is a thing you can speak about as part of archetype

00:32:50

Tim Benniks: it that might actually work. And Patrick, that gives us a little bit more meat on that bone to discuss because two has a bit more.

Everett Zufelt: Cool.

Tim Benniks: Okay.

Everett Zufelt: Let me know uh if I can help at all.

Tim Benniks: And awesome.

Everett Zufelt: Otherwise, I'll look forward to a poll request.

Tim Benniks: So once we know it's probably going to be quite quick

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah.

Tim Benniks: and maybe not everybody knows, but like where I work, our reorganization was huge. And so it's been chaos for like 3 weeks now. and I've lost all my engineers and I'm re figuring out how to now work and now AI first

Rebecca Lyus: Heat.

Tim Benniks: and all that stuff. So it's a little crazy and so hence not that much was done but it's in my mind but there you go.

Rebecca Lyus: That sounds like chaos.

Tim Benniks: Oh yes, like colleagues in DMs, can you please find me a job kind of thing like it's it's quite rough at the moment, but lots of companies go through this. Um it's just for us it was it's a bigger one than we anticipated.

00:33:56

Tim Benniks: So it's a real big reorganization,

Rebecca Lyus: Mhm.

Tim Benniks: but it also shows how can we use AI to actually then still, you know, perform. It's it's a really interesting one.

Everett Zufelt: Great.

Tim Benniks: But with that in mind,

Everett Zufelt: That's all I've got.

Tim Benniks: sorry, go on Everett.

Everett Zufelt: I was just saying that's all I've got.

Tim Benniks: Yeah, same for me actually. Um, I'd better go I'll figure out with you a time and maybe we're good.

Patrick Bosek: I sent you a calendar link.

Tim Benniks: Yeah, I saw. Thanks.

Everett Zufelt: Thanks everyone.

Rebecca Lyus: I will post in the Slack seeing when people are available for a in-person meetup. Um just a quick would people want working group to so the adoption operations

Everett Zufelt: I'

Rebecca Lyus: involved or are you just wanting it you guys?

Tim Benniks: I'll just do all of them, right? What do you guys think?

Everett Zufelt: I'd exactly

Tim Benniks: The more the marrier.

Rebecca Lyus: I appreciate you making this easier for me.

Tim Benniks: Of course.

00:34:49

Tim Benniks: Like, no, we only our little, you know, posy now. Let's Let's just Everybody thinks the same anyways.

Rebecca Lyus: This is it. And it'll be nice and then you can cross talk,

Tim Benniks: Exactly.

Everett Zufelt: what do I eat in Amsterdam?

Rebecca Lyus: right?

Everett Zufelt: Is it country? What What do I eat in Amsterdam?

Rebecca Lyus: Stroop and waffle.

Tim Benniks: Stroke waffle.

Everett Zufelt: Oh. Oh,

Tim Benniks: Really?

Everett Zufelt: I do like it. Oh,

Tim Benniks: Yeah.

Everett Zufelt: that's good.

Tim Benniks: But please, Ever, I'll tell you, don't go to like the strobe waffles where you pay like 20 bucks for them because they're just tourist

Rebecca Lyus: Oh god, no.

Tim Benniks: traps.

Everett Zufelt: But and don't get the ones from United.

Tim Benniks: No, especially not Well, those are probably closer to the ones you buy in Amsterdam.

Everett Zufelt: They're actually not bad.

Tim Benniks: Yeah, exactly. Go to just simple supermarkets. They'll be actually the best.

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah.

Everett Zufelt: Interesting.

Tim Benniks: But like we're really good at fries. Um,

Rebecca Lyus: Oh,

Tim Benniks: so but it's not French fries. It's kind of there a bit bigger and yeah,

Rebecca Lyus: junk tries.

Everett Zufelt: Was with mayo with mayo. Oh,

Tim Benniks: especially with Yo,

Everett Zufelt: there we go.

Tim Benniks: that's the thing. But we also have great fish and like it's we have sour or salty fish and there's like it's raw. You think it's crazy, but you're going to love it. Let's see if around that time of the Mac X conference if all that stuff is in season.

Everett Zufelt: Excellent.

Rebecca Lyus: Yeah.

Tim Benniks: I'll I'll try and find you guys a list or stuff to Yeah.

Everett Zufelt: Excellent. Excellent. All right.

Tim Benniks: Sure.

Everett Zufelt: Talk to you guys soon.

Rebecca Lyus: All right. All right. Bye.

Daniele Stroppa: Thanks.

Transcription ended after 00:36:10

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